



Comparison

MERN · Wix · GoDaddy · WP · Bolt · Lovable · Base44

Summary

Control vs simplicity: custom (MERN) = unique build; builders = fast move-in; AI = prototype only, security risks.

</> ① MERN stack (from scratch)

✓ Pros — MERN

- ✍ **Unlimited design** – no template limits, unique brand
- 🔧 **Tailored logic** – built exactly for your business
- 📁 **Full ownership** – code & data, no lock-in
- 🚀 **SEO speed** – SSR, fast indexing

✗ Cons — MERN

- 💰 **High upfront** – dev team, months
- 🔧 **Maintenance** – updates, patches, server
- 👤 **Dev needed** – you depend on experts
- 🛡 **Security on you** – PCI, audits

② Traditional builders (Wix · GoDaddy · WordPress)

✓ Pros — builders

- 🕒 **Launch days/hours** – drag & drop
- 💰 **Low monthly** – predictable cost
- 📁 **All-inclusive** – hosting, SSL, updates
- 🔧 **App ecosystem** – plugins, 24/7 support

✗ Cons — builders

- ✂ **Limited custom** – template/plugin boundaries
- 📁 **Scalability ceiling** – migration pain
- 🔒 **Platform lock-in** – no code ownership
- 💰 **Recurring fees** – subscriptions + transaction %

🤖 ③ AI-powered (Bolt · Lovable · Base44)

⚡ Pros — AI

- ⌚ **MVP in minutes** – prompt → prototype
- 🔧 **Non-tech bridge** – create without code
- 🔄 **Rapid iteration** – change via prompts

⚠ Cons — AI

- 🔍 **Major SEO fail** – client-side rendering blocks indexing
- 🛡 **Security risks** – AI-written vulnerabilities
- 🔧 **Hard to debug** – last 20% tweaks painful
- ❓ **Portability?** – export may break

📊 quick comparison

feature	MERN	traditional	AI builders
cost	high upfront	low monthly	moderate
launch time	months	days	hours
customization	unlimited	limited	AI limited
ease of use	dev needed	no code	easy start
scalability	excellent	hits limits	untested
ownership	full	rented	unclear
security	on you	managed	high risk
SEO	excellent	good	poor

👑 MERN

Complex/unique model, big scale, budget for dev team. Long-term custom asset.

🏠 Builder

Standard store, quick & cheap, small biz. WordPress gives most power.

🤖 AI (⚠)

Only prototypes/internal tools. Not for real e-commerce (security/SEO).

